BUSINESS MODEL ADAPTATION AND STRATEGIC TRANSFORMATION

An Integrated Qualitative and Quantitative Case Study of THG Hotel

Hospitality Strategy • Management Interviews • Investment Evaluation

Portfolio Report

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June 2024

Research focus: how a hospitality organization can evaluate differentiated services, external partnerships, and operational innovations when pricing power and implementation resources are constrained.

Abstract

This single-case research study investigates **business model adaptation** in **hospitality** through the integration of management interview analysis, operational and customer evaluation, and five-year investment appraisal. The evidence base combines a 20-question management Q&A, a 58-meaning-unit qualitative coding matrix, a 10-code codebook, and a linked financial evaluation of seven initiatives.

Five analytical themes emerge: **margin discipline and value capture**; **segment-sensitive service design**; **ecosystem-based service extension**; **implementation capacity and digital change**; and **evidence-based staged decision-making**. The financial model reports a combined five-year net present value (NPV) of approximately $12.90 million across seven modeled initiatives, with personalization and loyalty and premium-service upselling showing the highest estimated values.

Integration of qualitative and quantitative evidence suggests that the attractiveness of an initiative depends on incremental contribution, customer response, organizational readiness, partner governance, and the ability to test assumptions before scale-up. The study contributes a traceable **case-based** decision framework for prioritizing strategic developments.

Keywords: hospitality strategy; business model innovation; qualitative analysis; management interviews; investment evaluation; dynamic capabilities; partnerships; NPV.

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1. Introduction

Hospitality firms face a recurring strategic dilemma: rising labor, utilities, and service-delivery costs can compress operating margins even when revenue grows, while competition and perceived guest value constrain broad room-rate increases. The **THG Hotel** case provides an opportunity to examine how managers reason about alternatives to undifferentiated price increases and how strategic options can be evaluated systematically.

The guiding research question is: **How can a hospitality business facing cost pressure and constrained pricing power adapt its business model through service differentiation, organizational improvements, and external partnerships?** Three supporting questions ask **which managerial constraints matter**, **how the proposed initiatives create and capture incremental value**, and **how qualitative implementation conditions alter financial prioritization**.

The study makes two contributions. First, it organizes managerial reasoning into an structure. Second, it compares seven initiatives through a consistent investment appraisal. Its aim is analytical and decision-oriented.

2. Industry and Case Context

The THG Hotel is a hospitality business confronting rising operating expenses, modest booking growth, and limited latitude for general room-price increases. This consulting report and associated presentation identify potential responses involving personalized guest offers, loyalty, local service partnerships, premium upselling, events, digital check-in, themed-room offerings, and restaurant promotions.

The operating analysis uses its five California property data totaling 802 rooms. Its 2024 analytical data contains 293,532 available room nights, 212,997.36 occupied room nights, $39.44 million room revenue, $45.45 million total operating revenue, and $12.21 million operating contribution.

The case is analytically relevant beyond hotels because it connects service innovation to resource constraints, the economics of incremental transactions, interorganizational governance, and managerial experimentation.

3. Literature Review and Conceptual Framework

3.1 Business model innovation

Business models describe how an organization creates, delivers, and captures value. Osterwalder and Pigneur (2010) provide a useful architecture for distinguishing value propositions, customer segments, channels, partnerships, and revenue and cost logic. In the THG case, personalized offers and service bundles represent possible changes in value propositions and customer relationships; incremental margins determine whether additional value is captured.

3.2 Dynamic capabilities and implementation

Teece (2007) emphasizes sensing, seizing, and reconfiguring capabilities as foundations of strategic adaptation. Applied to THG, identifying guest segments is a sensing activity; piloting an upsell or partnership is a seizing activity; integrating systems, retraining staff, and adapting workflows involve

reconfiguration. The perspective cautions against treating an attractive NPV as sufficient evidence of organizational feasibility.

3.3 Service ecosystems and partnership governance

Service partnerships can expand the guest value proposition without requiring all services to be produced internally. Yet such extensions introduce coordination, quality-control, liability, refund, and revenue-sharing issues. Accordingly, partner-generated gross receipts must be evaluated against contribution margins and possible displacement of existing hotel spending.

3.4 Case study

Yin (2018) motivates the use of multiple documentary and analytical evidence streams in a bounded case. Gioia, Corley, and Hamilton (2013) highlight transparent movement from informant-level observations to higher-order concepts.

Conceptual proposition: strategic attractiveness is a joint function of expected incremental value, the reliability of demand and cost assumptions, organizational readiness, and partner or technology dependencies.

4. Research Methodology

4.1 Design and evidence corpus

A qualitative single-case design is combined with descriptive operating analysis and five-year investment evaluation. The qualitative interview comprises 20 management question–response pairs across six domains: strategic context; financial performance and operations; customer segmentation and loyalty; partnerships and service ecosystems; technology and organizational capabilities; and implementation and decision-making. Additional case evidence includes the presentation, and linked analytical workbooks.

4.2 Qualitative coding protocol

The 20 responses were segmented into 58 sentence-level meaning units, each assigned a question-based locator (for example Q01-MU01). Ten operational codes were applied deductively and refined against the supplied text. Multiple codes were allowed for a unit where more than one distinct concept was expressed. Five second-cycle themes were then developed by grouping related codes. The coding matrix records exact excerpts, modality, countervailing or boundary evidence, and review status. The coding represents a single-analyst review; code frequencies are descriptive and not statistical measures of managerial priority.

4.3 Financial model and integration

The investment appraisal compares seven initiatives over operating years 2025–2029, valued at the end of 2024 using a 10% discount rate. For each initiative, NPV is calculated as the discounted sum of projected incremental annual cash flows less launch investment, subject to the model's timing convention. The evaluation considers incremental service receipts, variable costs, implementation spending, and possible substitution of existing sales. Base-case results are interpreted together with downside scenarios, operational readiness, and the qualitative evidence matrix. The modeled financial results are scenario-based estimates, not realized earnings.

The integrated evaluation links each initiative to coded management considerations, feasibility conditions, and an implementation recommendation. This constitutes structured evidence integration.

5. Operational and Customer Analysis

Room occupancy shows of approximately 72.56% (212,997.36 occupied nights / 293,532 available nights). Room revenue represents approximately 86.79% of modeled total operating revenue. These ratios help locate the central strategic tension: opportunities to improve guest contribution cannot be evaluated solely through room rates or room volume, because ancillary revenue and the variable cost of delivering additional services also matter.

The case differentiates business, leisure, family, and group/event guests. Management dialogue suggests that segmentation should be checked against booking behavior, stay duration, price sensitivity, amenities, channels, and repeat-stay patterns. A useful subsequent test would connect offer exposure and redemption to guest-level contribution and repeat behavior.

Operating metrics recommended for monitoring include occupancy, average daily rate (ADR), revenue per available room (RevPAR), cost per occupied room, contribution per incremental transaction, and repeat-guest value. In particular, a nominal reduction in check-in time should not be booked as payroll savings unless paid labor hours fall or productive redeployment is demonstrated.

6. Management Interview Analysis and Qualitative Findings

6.1 Analytical approach and evidence base

The management interview analysis examines twenty question–response pairs organized into six substantive areas: strategic context, financial performance and operations, customer segmentation and loyalty, partnerships and service ecosystems, technology and organizational capabilities, and implementation and decision-making. Each response was segmented at the sentence level into meaning units, yielding 58 traceable excerpts (Q01-MU01 through Q20-MU02). A five interpretive themes were concluded from the text. Multiple codes were permitted where a single statement explicitly connected distinct concepts. The final codebook is supplied in the accompanying workbook.

The analysis focuses on management's decision criteria, proposed strategic mechanisms, and operational constraints. Because sentences sometimes contain more than one proposition, the sentence-level unit is a transparent pragmatic segmentation choice rather than a claim of minimal clause-level coding.

6.2 Theme 1: Margin discipline and value capture

A consistent thread is the distinction between growing sales and improving economic contribution. The interview identifies rising labor, materials, and utility costs as pressures that can erode margins even where revenue increases (Q01-MU02). Financial evaluation is framed in incremental terms, including net receipts, variable service costs, fixed requirements, initial investment, and potential displacement of existing sales (Q05-MU01). The respondent further states that decisions should rely on incremental cash flow rather than gross sales (Q05-MU02).

Pricing constraints make this distinction especially salient. Room rates are described as limited by guest expectations, competitive alternatives, brand positioning, and perceived value (Q03-MU01). Broad price increases may undermine conversion or customer trust (Q03-MU02). Accordingly, service differentiation and selective premium offers are presented as alternatives to generalized rate increases, but only where incremental contribution exceeds service costs and opportunity costs (Q03-MU03; Q06-MU02). This theme does not establish realized profitability gains: it identifies the economic criteria against which the proposed strategies should be judged.

6.3 Theme 2: Segment-sensitive service design

Management distinguishes business travelers, leisure guests, families, and group or event travelers as initial market segments, while emphasizing that segmentation should ultimately be checked against booking and spending behavior (Q07-MU01). Differences in stay length, price sensitivity, preferred amenities, booking channels, and return propensity imply that uniform offers are unlikely to be equally effective (Q07-MU02).

The interview characterizes packages as solutions to specific guest needs rather than simple combinations of discounted products (Q08-MU01). The illustrative contrast between business travelers seeking convenience and families preferring bundled experiences reinforces the need for differentiated value propositions (Q08-MU02). Loyalty performance is likewise assessed through incremental repeat stays and net spending after rewards and administrative costs, not membership enrollment alone (Q09-MU01–MU03). The key analytical boundary is that the interview articulates criteria for testing segment-specific propositions; it does not quantify observed segment-level effects.

6.4 Theme 3: Ecosystem-based service extension

External partners are presented as a way to broaden guest experiences without internalizing every service activity (Q10-MU01). The possible benefits include convenience, differentiated packages, and referral revenue (Q10-MU02). At the same time, the interview explicitly identifies partner availability, service standards, pricing, and customer support as governance dependencies (Q10-MU03).

The operational implications are concrete: guest targeting, responsibility allocation, commission terms, refund rules, redemption processes, and service-level expectations should be established before broader deployment (Q11-MU01). The respondent calls for tracking offer exposure, take-up, fulfillment, complaints, and incremental contribution in a limited pilot (Q11-MU02). Coupon usage alone is insufficient: management should test whether redemptions generate genuinely new spending or shift purchases from hotel outlets or other bundles (Q12-MU02–MU03). Thus, partnership strategies are simultaneously opportunities for service extension and sources of coordination, margin, and cannibalization risk.

6.5 Theme 4: Implementation capacity and digital change

The interview repeatedly treats organizational capabilities as prerequisites to scaling. For digital check-in, relevant considerations include property-management-system compatibility, vendor cost, cybersecurity, guest adoption, exception handling, and employee training (Q13-MU01). A digital service should demonstrate a measurable service improvement or reduction in staff time rather than being adopted solely because it is available (Q13-MU02–MU03). Moreover, time saved per arrival is not automatically equivalent to lower payroll expense: actual reductions in paid hours or productive redeployment would need to be established (Q14-MU01–MU02).

Corporate-event expansion is subject to a parallel capacity test. Meeting space, event operations, corporate sales capability, staffing, and coordination are identified as necessary inputs (Q15-MU01). The interview explicitly cautions that a positive modeled return does not itself establish feasibility where facilities or personnel are missing (Q15-MU03). Training is also treated as part of the investment, with offer eligibility, pricing, delivery, guest communication, and escalation procedures requiring operational preparation (Q16-MU01–MU03).

6.6 Theme 5: Evidence-based staged decision-making

The fifth theme integrates the other four. Management's prioritization criteria encompass incremental economic value, evidence quality, operational readiness, capital requirements, reversibility, and reliance on outside partners (Q17-MU01). Smaller, measurable initiatives may be appropriate for early pilots, while major technology and property investments should pass feasibility and data-validation gates (Q17-MU02–MU03).

At the property level, the interview identifies occupancy, average daily rate, revenue per available room, operating contribution, and cost per occupied room as relevant performance indicators (Q18-MU01). Initiative-level metrics include conversion, service margin, repeat stays, partner redemption, staff time saved, satisfaction, and investment cash flow (Q18-MU02). The respondent recommends specifying thresholds before a pilot and extending testing rather than scaling when effects cannot be reliably measured (Q19-MU01–MU03). These statements provide the basis for a stage-gated investment framework rather than an unconditional ranking based on modeled financial value.

6.7 Cross-theme synthesis and negative-case review

The five themes jointly suggest a management logic in which differentiated services and external partnerships create potential guest value, incremental contribution determines whether that value can be captured, and organizational capabilities determine whether implementation is viable. The interview includes explicit countervailing considerations: room-price increases may reduce conversion (Q03); premium upgrades may displace higher-value bookings (Q06); loyalty enrollment may overstate incremental retention (Q09); partner sales may conceal poor margins (Q11); coupons may cannibalize other spending (Q12); digital time savings may not translate into payroll reductions (Q14); and event investments may be infeasible without appropriate facilities (Q15). These qualifications are analytically important because they limit any interpretation of a positive financial estimate as sufficient evidence for immediate rollout.

The interview analysis therefore contributes a structured set of strategic mechanisms, implementation conditions, and testable propositions.

7. Strategic Alternatives and Investment Evaluation

The financial evaluation retains seven distinct initiatives, avoiding overlap between restaurant-related bundles and coupon partnerships through a 65%/35% allocation of the modeled restaurant opportunity. This allocation prevents duplicate assignment within the model but does not itself prove that purchases are incremental to existing spending.

Strategic initiative	Base-case five-year NPV (USD)	Rank
Personalization and loyalty	$5,389,886	1
Premium-service upselling	$2,342,990	2
Corporate events	$1,335,915	3
Local partnership bundles	$1,283,232	4
Digital check-in and mobile key	$1,203,503	5
Restaurant coupon partnerships	$692,826	6

Seasonal themed rooms	$655,379	7

The seven modeled NPVs total approximately $12.90 million. Personalized offers and loyalty account for the largest estimated value, followed by premium upselling. The ranking is a valuation comparison, not a ranking of measured realized profitability or a mandate for immediate implementation. Sensitivity to uptake, service margins, cannibalization, capital intensity, and organizational capability must inform deployment decisions.

8. Integrated Strategic Feasibility Assessment

8.1 Integration framework

The integrated assessment connects three evidence layers: (i) strategic alternatives developed in the THG Hotel case; (ii) the management interview's qualitative assessment of value creation, incremental economics, partnerships, and organizational readiness; and (iii) the five-year investment evaluation recorded in the project workbooks. Financial value is interpreted alongside operational feasibility and evidence strength, rather than as a standalone implementation decision.

The seven alternatives are personalization and loyalty, premium upselling, corporate events, service bundles, digital check-in and mobile key, restaurant coupons, and themed rooms. The investment model's five-year NPVs are model outputs based on its input assumptions and projected cash flows. In the base-case evaluation, the indicative NPVs are approximately $5.390 million, $2.343 million, $1.336 million, $1.283 million, $1.204 million, $0.693 million, and $0.655 million, respectively.

8.2 Personalization and loyalty

Personalization and loyalty have the highest base-case five-year NPV in the investment evaluation. Qualitative support derives from the interview's emphasis on segment-specific demand, differentiated packages, and incremental repeat stays (Q07–Q09). However, loyalty enrollment and gross repeat business cannot be treated as incremental value without distinguishing behavioral change from repeat visits that would have occurred anyway (Q09). The appropriate implementation sequence is to verify guest segmentation and baseline purchase behavior, then test targeted offers against a comparison condition. Key indicators include incremental conversion, repeat-stay contribution, discount costs, and reward administration.

8.3 Premium upselling

Premium upselling has the second-highest base-case five-year NPV. The management interview provides a clear contribution-margin criterion: incremental upgrade receipts must exceed service costs and the opportunity cost of limited premium inventory (Q06). It also identifies staff training, inventory visibility, and guest experience consistency as requirements. A controlled, property-level upselling pilot is therefore preferable to immediate broad deployment. Performance should be assessed using net upgrade contribution, displacement of higher-value bookings, guest satisfaction, and training or execution costs.

8.4 Corporate events

Corporate events offer a modeled investment opportunity but carry substantial property-specific feasibility requirements. The interview identifies meeting space, event operations, corporate sales capacity, staffing, and coordination as prerequisites (Q15). A capability audit should precede a commitment to event-related capital expenditure. The existence of a positive five-year NPV is not evidence that the relevant hotel

properties possess the necessary facilities or personnel. Demand validation, capacity utilization, event contribution margins, and staffing requirements should be evaluated together.

8.5 Service bundles and restaurant coupons

The bundle and coupon strategies share a partnership ecosystem and must be evaluated together to avoid double counting or shifting revenue between initiatives. The interview supports partner-based service extension (Q10), while emphasizing responsibilities, commission terms, refunds, service levels, and redemption tracking (Q11). It also explicitly warns that coupons can substitute for existing hotel outlet purchases or for other bundles (Q12). A joint pilot with unique offer identifiers, transparent partner settlements, and incremental contribution analysis would help distinguish genuine market expansion from internal displacement. The two financial model lines should remain analytically separate while sharing a common cannibalization check.

8.6 Digital check-in and mobile key

Digital check-in is linked to technology integration and service-delivery efficiency, not simply to room-revenue growth. The interview identifies property-management-system compatibility, cybersecurity, vendor fees, adoption, exception handling, and staff training as feasibility criteria (Q13). It further distinguishes staff minutes saved from actual reductions in paid hours (Q14). Investment approval should therefore depend on a technical compatibility review, measured arrival-processing times, guest adoption, exception rates, and demonstrable cost avoidance or productive redeployment. Treating nominal labor time savings as realized cash savings without validation would overstate the economic case.

8.7 Themed rooms

Themed rooms have the lowest modeled five-year NPV among the seven alternatives. The interview supports the broader rationale for differentiated guest experiences and selective willingness-to-pay testing (Q03), but it contains no direct discussion of themed-room design, renovation costs, or guest uptake. This is the weakest direct interview linkage in the strategy map. A defensible next step is to test willingness to pay, refurbishment downtime, property suitability, and incremental maintenance costs before treating the initiative as implementation-ready.

8.8 Stage-gated decision architecture

The combined evidence supports a four-stage process. Gate 1 — Baseline validation: verify current occupancy, customer behavior, unit economics, and property-level capabilities. Gate 2 — Limited feasibility testing: assess segment-specific offers, premium upgrades, and partnership packages through controlled pilots, while conducting technical and facility audits for digital and event investments. Gate 3 — Incremental value confirmation: measure actual contribution net of costs, cannibalization, exceptions, and service-quality changes. Gate 4 — Scale decision: expand only where prespecified financial and operational thresholds are met, with a named owner and ongoing monitoring. This sequence is a research-derived recommendation, not a claim that THG has already executed these gates.

8.9 Interpretation and research contribution

The integrated analysis yields three propositions. First, service differentiation creates financial value only to the extent that additional purchases are incremental and their contribution exceeds delivery and displacement costs. Second, partnership-based innovation extends the service offering while introducing governance dependencies that must be measured and managed. Third, organizational readiness and evidence quality mediate the practical significance of modeled investment value.

The contribution of the THG Hotel case is a transparent decision framework that links management reasoning to investment evaluation and implementation criteria. Its principal limitation is that management judgments, modeled cash flows, and implementation recommendations are different forms of evidence. The study does not contain verified post-implementation outcomes demonstrating that the modeled NPVs were realized. Further empirical work would require transaction-level contribution measures, property-specific operating records, partner terms, and appropriately designed pilots.

9. Discussion

The qualitative and financial evidence converge on a central result: the economic logic of strategic adaptation is conditional on incremental value capture. Management emphasizes contribution rather than sales alone, while the model shows how optimistic demand and margin assumptions can produce large positive NPVs. The appropriate interpretation is therefore a disciplined set of investment hypotheses, not proof of realized financial impact.

Business model innovation explains why differentiation, guest segmentation, and partnerships are plausible strategic responses to constrained room-rate growth. Dynamic capabilities explain why technology compatibility, staff training, event infrastructure, and managerial coordination shape feasibility. Partnership ecosystem reasoning explains why externally supplied guest experiences generate both potential value and governance risks. Together these perspectives connect value creation to value capture and implementation conditions.

Three propositions follow. P1: targeted service innovations are more likely to improve contribution when incremental uptake and displacement can be measured. P2: partnership offerings require contractual and operational governance to translate guest appeal into net value. P3: the relationship between modeled investment attractiveness and implementation priority is moderated by evidence quality and organizational readiness.

10. Managerial Implications and Implementation Roadmap

Gate	Management task	Decision evidence
1. Baseline validation	Confirm demand, margin and existing-service overlap	Guest-level receipts; contribution margin; segment baselines
2. Feasibility testing	Assess staff, technology, partner and facility requirements	PMS compatibility; training needs; service-level terms
3. Controlled pilot	Test targeted offers and track incremental effects	Offer exposure; take-up; net contribution; complaints
4. Scale decision	Compare verified outcomes with thresholds and alternatives	Net incremental cash flow; operational capacity; downside risks

Personalization and loyalty should begin with customer-data validation. Premium upselling is suitable for a controlled offer pilot. Bundles and restaurant coupons should be jointly monitored for substitution and partner performance. Corporate events require a property capability audit. Digital check-in requires systems and labor-savings feasibility studies. Themed rooms should await evidence on willingness to pay and renovation downtime. These are case-derived recommendations.

11. Limitations and Future Research

The study is bounded by a single hospitality case and a limited management Q&A corpus. The report and presentation originate from the student team, so the agreement is not independent corroboration of corporate outcomes. The resulting five-year NPVs have not been validated against post-implementation THG cash flows.

Future work should test actual incremental contribution through randomized or staggered pilots, and investigate whether the decision framework generalizes to other service-intensive organizations. A second independent coder and explicit adjudication log would further strengthen the qualitative audit trail.

12. Conclusion

The THG Hotel case demonstrates a practical integration of management interview analysis, operating economics, investment appraisal, and strategic feasibility assessment. Its 20 management Q&A pairs yielded 58 coded meaning units and five themes that foreground contribution margins, customer heterogeneity, partnership governance, organizational capabilities, and staged evidence-based decisions. The financial analysis evaluates seven alternatives and reports a combined base-case five-year NPV of approximately $12.90 million.

The main research conclusion is not that the highest-NPV alternative should automatically be adopted, but that investment decisions should depend on validated incremental value, implementation readiness, and reversible experimentation. This framework offers a transferable way to translate qualitative strategic reasoning into explicit managerial decisions.

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14. Appendices

Appendix A. Final qualitative codebook

Code	Operational definition	Units
COST_PRESSURE	Cost escalation and margin compression	4
PRICING_CONSTRAINT	Constraints on rate increases and price positioning	4
SEGMENTATION	Customer heterogeneity and segment validation	6
INCREMENTAL_ECONOMICS	Incremental contribution, opportunity costs and investment evaluation	24
PARTNER_GOVERNANCE	Partner contracts, dependencies and service accountability	10
DIGITAL_READINESS	Technical integration and digital operational feasibility	5
CAPABILITY_READINESS	Staffing, training, facilities and execution readiness	22
PILOT_MEASUREMENT	Pilot testing, success thresholds and performance monitoring	25
LOYALTY_VALUE	Repeat behavior and loyalty program net effects	4
SERVICE_DIFFERENTIATION	New services, customization and	9

	guest value	

Appendix B. Interview source map and audit protocol

Interview sections: strategic context (Q01–Q03); financial performance and operations (Q04–Q06); customer segmentation and loyalty (Q07–Q09); partnerships and service ecosystems (Q10–Q12); technology and organizational capabilities (Q13–Q16); implementation and decision-making (Q17–Q20). Each meaning unit retains an exact excerpt and original locator in THG_Final_Meaning_Unit_Coding.csv.

Traceable excerpts:

Q01-MU01 [CAPABILITY_READINESS;SERVICE_DIFFERENTIATION] — A hotel management organization must balance guest experience, room demand, operating efficiency, and owner expectations.

Q02-MU02 [SEGMENTATION;PILOT_MEASUREMENT] — We would examine occupancy by month and segment, booking lead times, channel mix, cancellations, competitive positioning, and repeat-stay patterns.

Q05-MU01 [INCREMENTAL_ECONOMICS] — We would estimate incremental demand, net receipts per transaction, variable service-delivery costs, fixed operating requirements, initial investment, and possible displacement of existing revenue.

Q08-MU03 [PILOT_MEASUREMENT;INCREMENTAL_ECONOMICS] — We would test the offer, measure incremental conversion and contribution, and compare outcomes against guests who did not receive it.

Q12-MU03 [INCREMENTAL_ECONOMICS;PARTNER_GOVERNANCE] — We would examine whether a coupon creates a new purchase, shifts a purchase from an existing hotel outlet, or substitutes for a bundle the guest would otherwise have bought.

Q17-MU03 [CAPABILITY_READINESS;PILOT_MEASUREMENT;DIGITAL_READINESS] — Larger technology or property investments should pass feasibility and data-validation gates first.